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ANNOUNCEMENTS

SUBJECT

2:07 P.M. (L)

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White House Press Filing Center
Lobbyist Hotel
Boykirk, Ireland

October 12, 1988

THAT MYRICK
LARRY ALFRED

Office of the Press Secretary
Boykirk, Ireland

THE WHITE HOUSE

(307)

THE WHITE HOUSE
Office of the Press Secretary
(Reykjavik, Iceland)

Press, Mr. Speaker

LARRY SPEAKS

October 12, 1986

White House Press Filing Center
Loffleidir Hotel
Reykjavik, Iceland

2:07 P.M. (L)

MR. SPEAKS: Let me have your attention, please.

The President and General Secretary Gorbachev have agreed to reconvene their face-to-face meeting at 3:00 p.m. at Gofdi House. The two will continue the discussions which they have held here for the last two days and, particularly, a continuation of the morning session that has concluded at 1:30 p.m. this afternoon.

In addition, Secretary Shultz, Foreign Minister Shevardnadze are reconvening now at Gofdi House to continue discussions in a separate meeting which the two leaders will join at 3:00 p.m. They will be joined -- Shultz and Shevardnadze will be joined in their meetings by arms control experts from both sides.

The plans for the remainder of the afternoon are that once the 3:00 p.m. meeting concludes, Secretary Shultz will come here to the briefing room to report on the meeting. President Reagan will stop briefly at the embassy and then go directly to the airport where he will greet the families of the personnel there, make his remarks, and then leave for Washington. That is the present plan, and you can see how the situation is going. But that's our present thought at the moment.

There is a story on the wire and a statement by a high-ranking Soviet official regarding the content of the discussions and prospects for agreement. My answer to that is, first of all, this is a flagrant and open violation of our agreement and the agreement between the two leaders that this should be personal and private talks. We now consider ourselves free to discuss what has occurred in the meetings in some detail, yet preserving the confidentiality so the two can continue this afternoon.

The two leaders have made progress in discussing a wide range of arms control issues. They have narrowed their differences in some cases and in others they have not. President Reagan has very firm beliefs, as you know, on specific issues in regard to U.S. positions on INF, on START, and on our Strategic Defense Initiative. I can tell you that the President is hanging tough on these issues. The President has presented his positions forcefully and there has been give and take on both sides. But, for the President's part, he wanted the opportunity to sit down and to continue to try to narrow these differences. But, once again, the President will not give in on his basic principles here.

Q What's he being asked to give in on?

MR. SPEAKS: Now -- I'm not going any further detail --

Q Why not?

NOTE

01002-18/10

MR. SPEAKES: -- on those specific subjects, but I will give you that much.

Charles?

Q: The Soviet statement said that they are close on the agreements on both INF and START. Would you concur with that statement?

MR. SPEAKES: I would hope that the Soviet spokesmen are not engaging in a propaganda effort in order to bring pressure on us on the arms control discussion table. It is my hope that they are simply speculating, and speculating in all good will and not with some ulterior motive in mind to bring public pressure on the two leaders who are engaged in very intense and, hopefully, private discussions.

Q: Well, are you saying --

Q: That's not a denial --

Q: -- that the Soviets are doing this because they want to --

MR. SPEAKES: Wait a minute. Hold up. Let's don't try to override each other. Now, we will -- I will stay here until about a quarter until 1:00 p.m., when I want to go back over there for the start of the meeting.

Charles?

Q: If I can follow. That's not a denial of the substance of Mr. Volikhev's statement?

MR. SPEAKES: His statement indicated -- give me that -- again.

Q: Progress on both INF and START --

Q: Deep cuts in long-range missiles.

Q: -- cuts --

Q: -- approaching agreements --

MR. SPEAKES: I would characterize it as some progress, but I would not characterize that there has been any agreement reached in those areas and will not be until we have an opportunity to talk further this afternoon.

Sam?

Q: Well, in suggesting the Soviets may be engaging in a propaganda campaign, are you saying that by --

MR. SPEAKES: No, I was expressing the hope that they were not.

Q: Well, by expressing that hope are you saying that by breaking elegantly, as you put it, the ground rule for the blackout that they're trying to put themselves in a position that if they don't reach agreement they can blame President Reagan for it.

MR. SPEAKES: I think that would be a futile exercise.

Q: Larry?

Q: Larry, you said something about that there is no agreement until they meet this afternoon. Are you raising the possibility that there may be agreements as opposed to incentives or

impulse, in the negotiations -- we might get an agreement -- an error
in our daily?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't think that one could speculate
point that far. I think it would be erroneous at this time to
speculate.

Q Where is the progress?

Q Larry?

Q Getting back to the substance of what the Soviet
spokesman had said, we're talking about progress in both the
long-range and INF -- that -- so you're talking about the possibility
of some closure in both these cases?

MR. SPEAKES: You have to be very careful with the words
you're using. We have had discussions, they have been vigorous
discussions. The President has made his points. General Secretary
Gorbachev has made his points. There is more discussion to be done
this afternoon, so it would be dangerous to draw conclusions. But I
certainly can confirm that they have had discussions in START and INF
and Strategic Defense Initiative and testing. And we will continue
these discussions this afternoon, but don't draw conclusions.

Leu?

Q Larry, is there a -- for our guidance, even if you
don't know, is there a possibility now that if they do have more
progress that they would come and make a -- some kind of a joint
statement, either an informal or formal basis?

MR. SPEAKES: The two have not discussed the possibility
of a joint appearance.

Q What is your crystal ball and tell us on when this
is going to conclude and when would we be briefed and when -- and
would we have more time here to --

MR. SPEAKES: Yes. It's difficult to say -- a 3:05 p.m.
meeting -- how long will it run -- I don't know. It would have been
-- you'd have been off the mark if you had predicted today's would
end at noon and it went to -- what -- 1:30 p.m. So, it's difficult
to say. Leu. I just don't want to say a few minutes or an hour or
more.

Q How about extra time to file?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes, we'll take as long as you want to stay
here.

Q Larry, could you say -- the expert talks on non-arms
control issues ended -- we've heard no more mention of that. Can you
tell us whether these have concluded without agreements?

MR. SPEAKES: No. They have concluded and there will be
a -- the talks that were out -- the other talks, other than arms
control -- have they concluded? Yes, they concluded this morning.
There has been no further expert talks in there, but there has been
an agreement in these talks, in the various areas, and it's certainly
something that Secretary Shultz will report on...let me hasten to add
-- when I say agreement, there has certainly been a vigorous
discussion of the issues in all three subjects and Secretary Shultz
will be able to report on those discussions and what progress has
been made.

Q Well, is "agreement" a proper word?

SECRETARY: Yes. I said "progress" and we'll be able to

Q: In all three areas, including humanitarian?

MR. SPEAKES: Well, let's wait to see what he says.

Q: You would say --

MR. SPEAKES: Yes. No, I said I agree in these talks.

Q: On the question of a possibility of an actual arms agreement, you said you don't think that you can speculate that far. Did you mean that you can't speculate now on the outcome of the next round of talks that starts at 3:00 p.m., or that these talks are not likely to lead to any kind of formal agreement on reductions?

MR. SPEAKES: Well, I think the two -- we will be able to make a statement as to where we stand in these specific areas. And it will -- it could be characterized as progress, but as far as an agreement, which is a term that could be misunderstood, I wouldn't use it.

George?

Q: When you say the President is hanging tough on SDI, does that mean that --

MR. SPEAKES: What?

Q: You said he's hanging tough on some arms issues that he agrees about -- including SDI.

MR. SPEAKES: That's right. Okay. He has some issues he feels very strongly about on INF, some on START, some on testing, and some on SDI.

Q: Well, when you say he won't give in, does that mean that you lack with initial disfavor on the Soviet offer that was made yesterday? You're not ready to say that yet?

MR. SPEAKES: We've had discussions on it, but this is not something that -- arms control discussions are not issues that are usually resolved in a black and white sense. There's give and take in discussion on both sides.

Bernie?

Q: You said there'd been some agreement on arms control. Has there been some agreement on the whole human rights area?

MR. SPEAKES: I didn't say agreement, I said progress.

Q: Question?

Q: What about the whole human rights area?

MR. SPEAKES: Well, I think I'll let Secretary Shultz characterize these three areas of talks and let him do it.

Jim?

Q: Did you say whether or not there has specifically been progress on the question of your deal with GDS and the ABM Treaty?

MR. SPEAKES: I'm not going into that kind of detail.

Mike?

MORE

11/23/82

Q The President appeared to be carrying some papers when he said farewell to Gorbachev today, and now there are reports one is in. Can you say whether a joint statement is being prepared?

MR. SPEAKES: I think the two would certainly end up with something. Whether they would make it public or not, I don't know.

Q They have been talking about a summit date?

MR. SPEAKES: Jack?

Q You said that you can confirm that there have been discussions on SDI, INF, START and testing.

MR. SPEAKES: Yes.

Q Would your use of the word progress apply to all of those areas?

MR. SPEAKES: Well, I think we would have to wait until the end, I guess, in order to be able to see whether progress applies at the end as well. But I think that -- there's been a good, solid give-and-take, would be the better way to describe it -- progress in a general sense.

Sen17.

Q Larry, I'm curious as to why you think you have to tell us that the President will not give in on his basic principles here? Has that been questioned?

MR. SPEAKES: Well, if -- I don't know whether it has or not, but I want to make it plain.

Q Was Mr. Volikoun a member of either of the two Soviet working groups? We didn't get that list?

MR. SPEAKES: I wouldn't know him if I was to see him.

Q Larry, are they also close to agreement on setting a date for the Washington summit or does that hinge on what happens in 3:00 p.m. meeting?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know whether we're close to setting a date or not.

Q Okay. I need the final notecards, pool now to assemble, if you will.

Q Go ahead on the summit date.

MR. SPEAKES: Yes. I don't have anything on a summit date.

John?

Q Larry, one could easily speculate that verification is the sticking point on INF still. Would you steer us?

MR. SPEAKES: One can speculate on a lot of things, but I would discourage speculation.

Lee?

Q Larry, could you characterize a little bit more specifically the...

MR. SPEAKES: Hold all the racket down. Lee?

MORE

11902-10/12

Q Could you characterize a bit more specifically the purpose of the afternoon meeting? Is it essentially to button up the things that you have described?

MR. SPEAKES: Further discussion.

Q And is it further -- further give-and-take needed?

MR. SPEAKES: Further discussions.

Yes?

Q Larry, when you talked about progress or the possibility of an agreement --, I just want to be clear. Are you talking about progress towards an impetus to the negotiations or, in other words, framework, outlines or are you talking about the actual substance, cuts -- that an actual agreement could come out of this?

MR. SPEAKES: I would think that we should wait until it's over to talk about it.

Q Can't you --

MR. SPEAKES: No, I don't think I should.

Yes, ma'am. No.

Q Will you characterize the general atmosphere? Was it -- I mean, give-and-take means that they were friendly, positive and both trying to achieve something, or what is --

MR. SPEAKES: I think business-like. We could fall back on that phrase.

Q Yes, Larry, if the Soviets, as one of their officials reported today, are discussing deep cuts in strategic missiles then of necessity are we not discussing at least a delay, if not a scaling-down, of SDI?

MR. SPEAKES: Once again, you should wait until the conclusion of the meeting before you jump.

Q Larry, did you say whether specific summit dates have been discussed?

MR. SPEAKES: No, I did not.

Q Have they?

MR. SPEAKES: I just -- we'll wait on that.

Q That was my question.

Q Following the precedent of this morning, I yield my time to The Times.

MR. SPEAKES: To who?

Q Larry, could I just ask whether you would stick with your characterization of this series of meetings this weekend as a preliminary pre-summit meeting at which no agreements are expected to be reached?

MR. SPEAKES: Preliminary summit meeting. The word "agreements" is a very broad term. I'd wait until the end of it to say.

Q Were both leaders speaking from -- or either leader speaking from prepared notes, going over -- prepared proposals?

MR. SPEAKES: Both were, yes. They were referring to
last night's report.

Q Did the question of the summit come up -- on
Wednesday visiting the summit?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know where we stand on that
frankly.

Q Do you know of any American official that violated
the blackout rule, overtly or covertly, in the last 48 hours?

MR. SPEAKES: I haven't seen much in print. That's the
key test.

Q Excuse me if you covered this earlier, but what did
Reagan -- or the President wind up doing last evening? Did he drink
alone? Did he get any reports during the meeting?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know the answer to that. He was
reported this morning -- he got his reports this morning at 9:15 A.M.

Q But you don't know whether he --

MR. SPEAKES: But I don't know whether he --

Q The Gang of Three.

MR. SPEAKES: -- ate with those fellows or not.

Okay, had enough?

Q I'd like to pursue that question about an American
official -- any American officials violating a blackout agreement.
Do you know of any American officials privy to information about this
who have, in fact, briefed reporters in this room about the progress
of the meetings?

MR. SPEAKES: I'm the only one that's been in this room.

Q Any other rooms?

Q Would you answer the question? I would like an
answer to the question.

MR. SPEAKES: Do you know of anybody that's briefed
reporters in this room?

Q Any other room?

MR. SPEAKES: No, I don't know of anybody that's briefed
reporters in this room.

Q No, and I'm sorry --

Q Then let me ask the question directly. Have you,
openly or not openly, briefed on background or on the record any
reporters?

MR. SPEAKES: Mike, my job is to talk to reporters, and
that is what I do.

Q During a blackout?

Q Can I request that this is an affirmative?

MR. SPEAKES: Sure. What am I doing now?

Q About substance?

MR. SPEAKES: Talking about -- I talked about substance all week.

Q.. Well, what is a blackout?
MR. SPEAKES: What is a blackout. Blackout is don't report on what is going on in the meetings.

Q. Did you not do that last evening to The Post and The Times?

MR. SPEAKES: Colonel.

Q. Everybody in this room knows what we're talking about, and I think you probably do, too. And it's widely reported that you briefed The Times and The Post last night --

MR. SPEAKES: I talk to reporters all the time. That's my job.

Q. -- about the meetings in which --

MR. SPEAKES: I sat in my office until 2:00 a.m. Where were you?

Q. Oh, I don't come in your office at 2:00 a.m.

MR. SPEAKES: Well, you were welcome.

Q. I thought there was a news blackout.

MR. SPEAKES: You were welcome. George was there at 1:00 a.m. What did I do, George?

Q. I thought there was a news blackout.

MR. SPEAKES: Who observed the blackout when he came to us with something at 1:00 a.m.?

Q. Was the blackout observed --

MR. SPEAKES: Who observed the blackout when George came to me at 1:00 a.m.?

Q. I didn't know George did --

MR. SPEAKES: George did.

Q. -- or what he had in mind.

MR. SPEAKES: He had a story. And what did I say, George?

Q. Come on, George.

MR. SPEAKES: Come on, George.

Q. What did he say?

Q. You know I don't talk about it.

MR. SPEAKES: Don't want to talk about it?

Q. Speak up.

Q. That's right.

MR. SPEAKES: Pat Sloyan's got to go. Pick up the white courtesy phone.

Q. Were these one-on-one meetings -- were they one-on-one or were there other people in the room, Larry?

MR. SPEAKES: Okay, anything else?

Q. Yes, Larry.

MR. SPEAKES: Yes.

Q. Could you just explain why, at the public briefing last night, you said you couldn't characterize the thoughts about progress because it would violate the blackout, but later, privately, to several reporters, you did say, not for attribution, that there was progress made?

MR. SPEAKES: No.

Q. You did not quit -- you deny saying that, Larry, on background?

MR. SPEAKES: I'm not denying anything, Owen.

Saul?

Q. Larry, if the stories in The Post and The Times indicated that administration officials characterized the talks -- as informed sources -- would you consider that a violation of the blackout?

MR. SPEAKES: Look at the networks.

Q. Well, would you -- could you answer the question on whether you consider that -- those people who talk to The Times and The Post --

MR. SPEAKES: I'm not making judgments.

Q. Is the news blackout now officially over?

MR. SPEAKES: As far as I'm concerned, yes.

Q. Can you specify the names of --

MR. SPEAKES: Can anybody interpret? I'm sorry, I couldn't hear you. Can anybody relay?

Q. Can you specify the names of the --

MR. SPEAKES: No, I cannot. From this afternoon, they have not been determined by both sides.

Q. Larry, can you tell us anything about a plan --

Q. Larry, did you inform the Soviets you consider it over or are they just finding out via this briefing?

MR. SPEAKES: We made our representations to them.

Sah?

Q. Larry, did you or did you not, when we were back in Washington, when you told us there was going to be a blackout, tell us there were not going to be little backgrounders by senior officials during the course of the news blackout? I believe you're on the record on that very clearly, just as you were in Geneva.

MR. SPEAKES: If you want to settle these matters, why don't you show up in my office right now?

Q. Right now?

NORE

1963-12-12

MR. SPEAKES: Yes...

Q Sure.

MR. SPEAKES: Get up and go.

Q Don't tell me where to go, Larry. I'll meet you there.

MR. SPEAKES: You'd better. Okay, anything else?

Q Larry --

MR. SPEAKES: You're the man. Or you're the man.

Q Can you tell us anything about plans of administration officials who travel following the summit to brief allies and other friends?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes. Shultz and Rovny -- Shultz to NATO, Rovny and Nitso to the Far East. I don't have specifics.

Q Larry, is there any possibility this could go over until tomorrow?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know, Chris.

Q Is there any discussion of that at all?

Q Is that right about Nitso?

Q Have you asked them to hold our room?

MR. SPEAKES: Rovny and Adelman.

Q Any discussion of that at all?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know of any specific discussions. Yes?

Q Two questions. Was there any input to the negotiating team from the principals through the course of the evening, any consultation back and forth?

MR. SPEAKES: No. Oh, you mean in the evening?

Q During the evening working group.

MR. SPEAKES: Oh, yes. I believe they talked to Secretary Shultz in the evening.

Q The working group talked to Shultz?

MR. SPEAKES: Yes.

Q But not to the President?

MR. SPEAKES: No.

Q Or to Gorbachev?

MR. SPEAKES: I don't know.

Q And secondly, since this round of meetings seems to have gone considerably beyond the parameters that were described prospectively before we came to Iceland, can you explain what share

...about the report between the leaders of the way the meetings
were conducted that caused it to get into this kind of negotiations

MR. SPEAKES: No, I think it was an opportunity to
discuss. We generally gave you guidance that we didn't expect any
agreements to be signed, as the President said. We knew it was a
discussion and we couldn't predict the outcome; I still can't.

Q Were the meetings today one-on-one, or were there
other people in the room?

MR. SPEAKES: I've covered that.

Q Did you say it?

Q You've really got to be certain you look at them.
(Laughter.)

MR. SPEAKES: Mike, you working, or do you want Wern to
take your row?

Q Thank you.

END

2:30 P.M. (1)

MR. SPEAKES: No, I think it was an opportunity to
discuss. We generally gave you guidance that we didn't expect any
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